WOOF GANG BAKERY & GROOMING

THE PACK PLAYBOOK | EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK | NOVEMBER 2026

Port Washington • Hicksville • Glen Cove

Welcome to the pack! At Woof Gang, every pup deserves gentle hands, every pet parent deserves a great experience, and every teammate deserves respect. These are the everyday rules that help us deliver happy tails at every location. Store procedures, role-specific instructions, and applicable law also apply. Each location is operated by its respective employing entity.

1 Welcome to the Pack

- Our pack promise: treat every pup with compassion, every customer with care, and every teammate with respect. Safety, cleanliness, professionalism, and teamwork come first.
- Be the reason tails wag: greet customers warmly, communicate clearly, and treat coworkers respectfully.
- Harassment, discrimination, retaliation, threats, theft, impairment at work, and falsification of records are prohibited.
- Employment is at will unless otherwise required by law or a signed agreement.
- This handbook is not a contract or guarantee of employment, compensation, or benefits.
- Management may revise policies subject to applicable law.
- Employees may raise concerns without retaliation.

THE WOOF GANG WAY | Every Pup. Every Customer. Every Visit.

More than grooming: it is how we treat every pup and every person.

- TREAT EVERY DOG LIKE YOUR OWN - Handle dogs with patience and compassion; never rush at the expense of safety.
- MAKE EVERY CUSTOMER FEEL SPECIAL - Greet warmly, listen closely, and communicate honestly.
- TAKE PRIDE IN EVERY GROOM - Check the details and the finished result before every pickup.
- ONE PACK, ONE TEAM - Help coworkers, show respect, and take ownership of mistakes.
- KEEP OUR SHOPS LOOKING THEIR BEST - Clean, organize, and restock throughout the day.
- GO ABOVE AND BEYOND - Look for small ways to make each visit memorable.

Our pack promise: every pup with love, every customer with care, every teammate with respect.

2 Show Up for the Pack | Attendance & Scheduling

- Be ready to work at the exact scheduled start time.
- All required setup, cleaning, and closing work must occur on paid time; accurately record every hour worked.
- No off-the-clock work.
- Overtime requires advance approval, but all overtime actually worked must be reported and paid as required by law.
- If absent or late, text BOTH Kyle and Cindy as soon as you know.
- Emergencies and protected leave are handled according to law.

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- Submit time-off requests, shift swaps, and changes to regular availability through the Schedule Change Portal as soon as possible.
- Management must approve changes; employees cannot independently arrange shift swaps.
- Employees remain through scheduled shift end even when appointments cancel or finish early.
- Early departure requires management approval.
- Complete assigned closing duties before leaving.
- Management coordinates meal breaks in accordance with New York law; unpaid meal breaks must be duty-free and recorded accurately.
- Employees receive legally required sick/safe leave and other protected leave in accordance with applicable law and separate company notices.
- No additional holiday premium or paid holiday benefit is promised unless required by law or separately communicated.

3 Pay, Perks & Vacation Stipend

- Standard groomer compensation is 50% commission on eligible grooming service revenue unless individual written terms provide otherwise.
- A new groomer may receive an individually agreed daily guarantee for the first 90 days: for a full scheduled day worked, pay is the greater of daily commission or that guarantee, plus tips.
- Partial days are paid on commission plus tips, subject to all minimum-wage, overtime, and other wage requirements.
- Tips belong to the groomer performing the service and are separate from any daily guarantee.
- Managers and owners do not retain employee tips.
- Employees must accurately report tips under applicable procedures.
- Referral bonuses, performance reviews, and raises are discretionary unless otherwise agreed in writing.

Vacation stipend — eligible full-time groomers only

- A full-time groomer regularly scheduled at least four days per week becomes eligible after six continuous months of employment.
- Rehire restarts eligibility.
- Eligibility pauses while regularly scheduled below four days and resumes when full-time status is restored, provided the service requirement is met.
- The benefit resets each January 1, with no carryover or first-year proration.
- Request vacation at least three weeks in advance; approval depends on staffing and operations.

Continuous service	Annual stipend days	Daily stipend
6 months–under 3 years	5	$100
3–under 4 years	6	$115
4–under 5 years	8	$130
5–under 7 years	10	$150
7–under 10 years	10	$175
10+ years	10	$200

- November–December requests are generally discouraged but may be approved.
- Only full regularly scheduled days off qualify; no partial-day stipend, and stipend days within a vacation week cannot exceed the employee's normal weekly workdays.

- The groomer must specifically request stipend use for approved days; time-off approval alone does not authorize payment.
- Approved stipends are processed through regular payroll.

4 Every Pup, Every Time | Grooming Standards

- Groomers personally check in with customers before every appointment to confirm haircut preferences, service requests, health/skin/coat concerns, and relevant instructions.
- Check records and required waivers.
- Explain significant matting, proposed shave-down, and any additional charges before proceeding; obtain customer authorization and applicable waiver.
- Groomers verify dog weight and coat classification for pricing; telephone quotes are “starting at.” Record relevant grooming preferences, behavior, coat condition, matting, and concerns in FranPOS after every appointment and before shift end.
- Notes must be factual and professional.
- Photograph significant matting, skin conditions, visible injuries, or other unusual concerns and save photos in an approved system.
- Before every happy tail heads home, complete a final quality and safety check: haircut accuracy, cleanliness, dryness, missed areas, and visible concerns.
- Using the designated grooming-area tablet, groomers message customers approximately 15 minutes before the dog is ready.
- Notify front-of-house promptly of delays and communicate revised pick-up times.
- Groomers personally release dogs to customers and review the completed service.
- If another dog is being groomed, a qualified coworker must safely supervise that dog before the groomer steps away; never leave a dog unattended on a table or in a tub.
- Groomers safely secure finished dogs; front-of-house staff help monitor dogs awaiting pick-up.
- Verify release to the owner or authorized person.
- Encourage rebooking and support filling cancellations and waitlists.
- Groomers may overlap appointments only while maintaining safe supervision and quality.
- Accept assigned, walk-in, and same-day appointments when time and staffing allow, absent legitimate safety, health, or animal-welfare concerns.
- Escalate such concerns promptly.

5 Happy Tails Start Here | Appointments & Service

- Only authorized front-of-house staff may add, cancel, move, block, or otherwise modify grooming appointments or durations in FranPOS.
- Groomers may request extra time for coat condition, behavior, size, or complexity; front-of-house staff make changes subject to management direction.
- Honor requests for a particular groomer where reasonably possible.
- For late arrivals, front-of-house calls at five minutes (and sends a courtesy text if unanswered) and calls again at 15 minutes.
- Consult groomer and management before accepting or rescheduling.
- Deposits are required for future appointments after one no-show or three same-day cancellations, under the store’s communicated terms.
- Report all customer complaints and significant grooming errors to management immediately.

- Employees may not independently authorize discounts, refunds, complimentary corrections, or other accommodations.
- The usual touch-up window is 72 hours, subject to management approval.
- Document concerns and resolutions in FranPOS.
- Groomers are expected to meet reasonable appointment durations without sacrificing animal safety or quality.
- Management may provide coaching and improvement expectations for repeated delays.
- Customer feedback, quality, safety, attendance, teamwork, and repeat bookings may inform performance reviews.

6 Safety First, Always | Pets & People

- Pups come first: never leave a dog unattended on a grooming table, in a tub, or in any unsafe situation.
- Use appropriate restraints and safe lifting; seek assistance with heavy dogs.
- Keep doors secured, prevent contact between dogs from different households, and follow kennel, dryer, muzzle, vaccination, and sanitation procedures.
- Never leave a muzzled dog unattended.
- If a dog becomes aggressive, distressed, ill, or otherwise unsafe to handle, stop the service, secure the dog safely, and alert management.
- A groomer may stop work immediately for safety; management determines next steps.
- Report every dog injury, bite, escape, near miss, or other incident immediately regardless of apparent severity.
- Document facts and relevant photos; management coordinates owner and veterinary communication.
- Employees must immediately report their own workplace injuries and hazards to management, seek appropriate care, and cooperate with accurate incident reporting.
- Management handles workers' compensation reporting.
- Retaliation for reporting an injury or exercising legal rights is prohibited.

7 Keep It Fresh | Cleanliness & Teamwork

- A clean shop is a happy shop: sanitize your station, tools, and equipment and pitch in with shared areas.
- Complete assigned opening and closing checklists during paid time.
- No pup on the table? Help the pack: clean, organize, restock, and support coworkers during schedule gaps.
- Employees must complete assigned duties before departure.
- Woof Gang generally supplies tables, tubs, dryers, and standard grooming products.
- Groomers generally supply and maintain personal scissors, clippers, and blades as agreed at hiring.
- Obtain the owner's permission before borrowing personal tools.
- Personal tools may be stored overnight in designated areas at the employee's risk, except as law requires otherwise.
- Report damage; ordinary wear and accidents are handled by management, without unlawful payroll deductions.
- Use store shampoos, conditioners, or other supplies for personal purposes only with management approval.

- Unauthorized removal is prohibited.
- Voluntary outside education and certifications are at employee expense; certifications are not generally required.
- Management may assess practical skills during hiring or for legitimate performance or safety concerns, with compensable assessment time paid.
- Additional training is generally voluntary except for significant safety or legal requirements.

8 Represent the Pack | Appearance & Conduct

- Wear a clean Woof Gang branded shirt or management-approved uniform and closed-toe, nonslip shoes.
- Jeans, leggings, athletic pants, and shorts are acceptable if clean, appropriate, and safe.
- Personal bags and coats belong in designated storage areas, not grooming stations or customer counters.
- Personal phone use is limited to breaks, emergencies, and authorized work.
- Company music is selected in advance by management; employees may not change playlists, stations, or volume or stream personal music during work.
- Stay alert to dogs, customers, and coworkers.
- Covered drinks may be kept safely at workstations; food is limited to designated break areas.
- Clean up after yourself.
- Personal visitors are not permitted during shifts except emergencies or management approval; no visitors in animal-care areas.
- Employees must follow location-specific parking instructions and avoid customer spaces unless approved.
- Personal dogs require prior management approval and may be brought only under conditions set by management.
- Employees may enter stores outside scheduled hours only with prior management approval.
- Do not share or duplicate keys or access codes; report missing keys or compromised codes immediately and return access materials when requested.
- Follow lawful smoking and vaping restrictions, including all company-property and safety rules.

9 At the Register | Payments & Perks

- All grooming and retail payments must be processed through FranPOS.
- Cash tips may be accepted directly.
- Immediately report register shortages, overages, or errors; never alter records to conceal discrepancies.
- Only management may authorize refunds, discounts, voids, or price changes.
- Credit-card surcharges, where implemented, apply only to eligible credit transactions, not debit or cash, subject to law and posted notices.
- Employees receive 20% off eligible retail merchandise; grooming services for personal dogs are full price.
- Shop only during breaks or outside scheduled shifts.
- Another authorized employee must ring up purchases; no self-checkout, and pay before taking merchandise.
- No combining discounts with promotions absent approval.

- Personal dogs' grooming appointments must be booked through FranPOS like customer appointments, subject to availability and management approval.
- Personal dogs may not disrupt customer appointments or operations.

10 Protect the Pack | Privacy & Communications

- Protect customer contact information, pet records, FranPOS data, vendor information, financial records, and other confidential business information.
- Do not use company lists, systems, devices, social accounts, or other resources to solicit private grooming clients.
- Lawful outside grooming work is permitted outside scheduled hours if it does not interfere with duties or misuse company property.
- All business-related customer scheduling and communications go through official channels.
- Do not use personal accounts or numbers for company business without approval.
- Work-related photos, videos, or posts featuring customers, pets, coworkers, or operations require management approval and appropriate customer consent.
- Only authorized employees may post to official accounts.
- Nothing in these policies restricts legally protected employee discussion of wages, working conditions, or other protected activity.

11 Accountability & Employee Rights

- Management may use coaching, warnings, suspension, or termination as appropriate; no fixed progressive sequence is promised.
- A single no-call/no-show may lead to discipline, subject to emergency and protected-leave exceptions.
- Employees are requested to provide two weeks' written resignation notice and return all company property.
- The company follows applicable wage, leave, anti-discrimination, accommodation, safety, and other employment laws.
- Where a policy conflicts with controlling law, the law governs.
- Employees may report concerns and exercise protected rights without retaliation.

12 Pack Promise | Gusto Acknowledgment

- All existing employees will receive this handbook through Gusto for electronic acknowledgment; new hires will acknowledge it during onboarding.
- Acknowledgment confirms receipt and responsibility to review and follow applicable policies, not agreement to an employment contract.
- Electronic records will be retained in Gusto.